The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Morndas, the 19th of Frostfall (Monday, October 19, 2026) ·
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Gandy dozes on the deck while Maevy watches the clouds go by.

Skies o'er the Hold

68° / 52°

Partly Cloudy

Sunrise 6:34 AM · Sunset 5:45 PM

Tomorrow — Partly Cloudy, 71/57

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday · *Tonight* — First Quarter · *Tomorrow* — Waxing Gibbous

waxing toward the full moon

19th of Frostfall = October 19

Months run one-for-one all year
Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Painters Take the Valley While the Holds Keep a Merry Morndas

Payson, Ariz.



Painters at their easels in the Verde Valley, turning red rocks and ranch light into pictures.

Hail, wayfarer, and good Morndas morning — the Rim wakes under soft travelling clouds, bound for 68 degrees after a 52-degree dawn, with the pines standing tall and the roads dry for wandering. The art holds the day: painters gather at D.A. Ranch in Cornville for the Sedona Plein Air Festival's golden-hour Paint Out, Prescott opens its own Plein Air Festival, and Camp Verde spreads its farmers market on Hollamon Street. By the Nine, friend of the Hearth, take a light cloak and go watch the valley turn into pictures.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Camp Verde**
  — Verde Valley Farmers Market — 9 AM–1 PM, 75 E Hollamon St, Camp Verde. The valley's Monday market fills the street with farm produce, baked goods, and handmade wares from local growers and makers. It is a friendly, walkable browse — the sort of morning where you arrive for tomatoes and leave with honey, bread, and a neighbor's whole life story. Stock the Hearth kitchen, chat with the farmers, and enjoy small-town Camp Verde at its merriest.

- **Sedona**

  — D.A. Ranch Paint Out — Sedona Plein Air Festival — 4–7 PM, D.A. Ranch, Cornville; $45 per guest, limited tickets. Festival artists paint across the ranch grounds from 4–6 PM, among the historic red barn, pastures, ponds, orchards, and vineyards, while you wander and watch the canvases grow. Awards and an exclusive sale of the works created that very afternoon follow at 6:30 PM. D.A. Ranch wines are for sale, with a grazing table and live music besides. Golden-hour art, wine, and music in the Verde Valley — a painter's quest with refreshments.

- **Prescott**

  — Prescott Plein Air Art Festival — opening day — today through Saturday, Oct. 24, at venues and outdoor painting spots around Prescott. Artists set up their easels across the old capital all week, painting its courthouse square, pines, and granite country in the open air while passersby watch the work take shape. It is a wandering sort of festival: stroll, find an artist, and see Prescott turned into pictures one canvas at a time. A fine excuse for a day trip over the hills, Valley Dwellers included.

The Days Ahead

- **Tue, Oct. 20**

  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — 7 AM–noon, on Hwy 87 just before Pine, with PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction. "Don't just use the trail — help build it": volunteers clear brush, move rocks, break roots, and shape a trail the community will use for years, and the work also creates better access routes for firefighters and emergency crews. Tools are provided; bring water, sunscreen, gloves if you have them, and sturdy shoes. Email trails@psfuelreduction.org for directions.

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — artist demonstration** — 1–3 PM, free, Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Rd, Sedona. A festival artist demonstrates the plein air craft live, turning red-rock light into a finished canvas in two hours while you watch. The festival runs through Saturday, Oct. 24, with 26 artists painting across Sedona and the Verde Valley. This free demonstration is the easiest way in — no ticket, just curiosity. Arrive a little early for a good spot.

- **Wed, Oct. 21**

  — **Paint Out at a Private Sedona Residence** — 4–7 PM, private Sedona residence, address with ticket; $60 per guest, limited tickets. The Plein Air Festival's most intimate evening: a small audience watches artists paint from 4–6 PM amid sweeping red-rock views. Awards and an exclusive sale of the afternoon's works begin at 6:30 PM. Wine, beer, and Southwest BBQ are served as the sun sets. Part art show, part garden party, part treasure hunt.

  — **Long-Term Water Management Plan Community Meeting** — 1–3 PM, Prescott Public Library, 215 E Goodwin St, Prescott. City staff open with a presentation on Prescott's water supplies, current and future needs, and strategies for conservation and efficiency. Information stations follow, where residents can talk one-to-one with City representatives and take a community survey. Can't attend? The survey is online, and your input still feeds the plan's first draft. Dry-country homework that truly matters.

- **Thu, Oct. 22**

  — **Camp Carpe Diem Verde Valley 2026 opens** — Oct. 22–25, basecamp at Verde River RV Resort & Cottages, Camp Verde; ticketed. A grown-up camp and "UnRally" for RVers, van-lifers, tent campers, and travellers: four days exploring the valley's hiking, biking, breweries, wineries, and ghost towns. The organisers handle the details; campers pick how much or how little to do, with community dinners along the way. This year's edition lands at peak fall colour. Come for the adventure; stay for the company.

- **Fri, Oct. 23**

  — **Paint & Sip "Three Ghosts"** — 6 PM, 100 N White Mountain Rd, Ste 101, Show Low. A Halloween-week paint night: settle in with a brush and a sip to create "Three Ghosts," a seasonal canvas to take home. The listing points painters to Kittles Fine Art for full information and registration under "Upcoming Classes." A relaxed Fredas-evening way to start the last weekend before Halloween. The ghosts, we are assured, are friendly ones.

- **Sat, Oct. 24**
  — **Morning Café — Unity of Payson** — 9:30 AM–12:30 PM, 110 E Bonita, Payson, and on Zoom every Saturday. A gentle, coffee-hour start to Loredas: good company and an uplifting talk to open the day. It runs every Saturday, so guests can join from the Hearth by Zoom without driving anywhere. Check unityofpayson.org for the blue Zoom link.
  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — closing day** — 10 AM–2 PM, Sedona. The festival's last day brings artist pumpkin painting, a community paint-out with a $15 registration — your own brushes welcome — and a final sale of the week's fresh paintings. Nine days of red-rock canvases come down to one morning: watch, paint, or carry a piece of Sedona home. A fine Loredas finale for art lovers, Valley Dwellers included.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The Hearth shield on the workbench, with the torch sconces lined up beside it.

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — draw the sconces and ready them before a single torch can burn.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue since Oct. 3 — the printers stand ready; give them their orders.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue since Oct. 10 — hang the finished torches and light the way.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Overdue since Oct. 17 — the Hearth's arms take shape at last.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Due Oct. 24 — hang it on a French cleat where every guest can see it.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Due Oct. 24 — the Hearth's doors are next on the quest board.

The shield build is overdue since Saturday, Oct. 17 — and the torches still wait, wanting their sconces printed and hung.

Merchant of the Hold

Noley's Books, Art & Whatnot · *Payson*



Books, art, coffee, and whatnot — all under one cozy roof.

A bookshop, art gallery, and coffee bar all in one cozy room on Highway 260 — shelves of books, walls of local art, locally made goods and gifts, and a counter serving good coffee, baked goods, and fresh bites. Guests can browse, play a game of chess, take tea or a pastry, and lose a happy hour among the whatnot. Some small kindly enchantment — call it the Whatnot Charm — keeps the coffee hot, the shelves curious, and every visit a little longer than planned.

> *"Hands down the best coffee and coolest spot in Payson. Love the atmosphere and friendly baristas."* — Google review

103 E Highway 260, Payson, AZ 85541 · Closed Mon; Tue–Thu 6:30 AM–5 PM; Fri 6:30 AM–7 PM; Sat 8 AM–5 PM; Sun 10 AM–4 PM · (928) 478-8998 · $ (inexpensive) · Good to know: closed on Mondays, so plan for Tuesday through Sunday — and leave time to browse, because nobody leaves in five minutes. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: Books, local art, and the best coffee in the Hold in one warm room — the Hearth's favorite refuge for guests who love to browse.

Tales from the Treeline

The Morning Jethro Jarred the Fog



One jar down — and Earl wears the weather with dignity.

Morndas dawned grey and drippy, and Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) announced that the low cloud over the Hearth was far too good to waste. He fetched a row of Mabel's canning jars and set about catching the fog to water her garden later, one jar at a time, waving each lid like a butterfly net.

Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) helped the only way he knows how, breathing a careful little ice-mist over each jar so the fog would stay put. It worked beautifully. The rims frosted, the fog settled, and Henny (the Hearth's chicken) supervised from the deck rail like a harbor master counting cargo.

Then Henny knocked the fullest jar off the rail. It did not break — it sighed. One small, perfect cloud rolled across the deck, and Earl (an elk) stepped into it up to his knees and stood there, very dignified, wearing the weather. Mabel (a wood elf) sighed her longest sigh, poured the other jars over her sage, and declared the garden officially watered by cloud. Jethro calls it a success. By the Nine, so does the sage.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Morndas be free of spiders, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com